

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a health and lifestyle magazine:

<u>Foods to Enhance Your Mood</u>	<u>Foods to Avoid</u>
✓ DARK CHOCOLATE ♦ People get a nice mood boost whenever they eat a bar of low sugar dark chocolate because of the chemicals in chocolate. ✓ PROTEIN ♦ Protein – like eggs, a piece of cheese or a handful of nuts – helps to keep your blood sugar levels steady for enhanced energy and mood. ✓ BANANAS ♦ Bananas contain a chemical that makes you feel happy. ✓ COFFEE ♦ Drinking a morning cup improves your general sense of wellbeing. ✓ BERRIES ♦ Berries which have a deep colour, like blueberries and blackberries, improve coordination, memory function and your mood. ✓ FISH ♦ Salmon and other fish reduce worry and depression.	Just as foods can lift your mood, they can also quickly bring it down. Here are the top three foods that can trigger a poor mood. * SUGAR Sugars in junk food, candy and soda can make you feel tired by changing your blood sugar levels. * WHITE BREAD, WHITE RICE AND WHEAT White bread and white rice may negatively impact mood and brain health. Wheat in particular has also been linked to mental health problems in some cases. * PROCESSED FOODS The list of ingredients in processed foods, including instant noodles, fish balls and ham, is a long one. They contain bad fats, artificial colours, monosodium glutamate (MSG), artificial sweeteners and other ingredients linked to bad temper, irritability and poor mood.

Your group is researching ideas for foods that improve the way students feel. You are discussing whether any of the items mentioned in the magazine would be suitable. You may want to talk about:

- foods in schools which are good or bad for your mood
- whether school menus should only offer healthy food
- the benefits of having mood-enhancing foods
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What healthy foods do you eat?
2. Do you think about the health benefits of the food you eat?
3. Are there any foods you don't eat because they are bad for you?
4. Do you worry about eating unhealthy food?
5. Are people today more aware of the importance of healthy food?
6. Apart from food, what else can change your mood?
7. How can you make sure you eat food that is good for your mood?
8. Why are so many foods that are bad for your mood popular with young people?